Solidarity March took to the streets on 29 November 2019 in at least fifty locations, with the principal activity being in Lahore. Their grievances went back to the reign of the military dictator Zia ul-Haq. It was he who banned student unions across the country in 1984, as he had become alarmed at their increasingly emboldened resistance. For thirty years, this ban had proscribed political activity on university and college campuses. It had imposed a culture of silence. The students were calling into question thirty years of silence, and their cause was being channelled through progressive student organizations which emulated the 2016 Lahore Students' Collective in its resolve to do the same. So now, dressed in black with red motifs and holding placards, the students fearlessly shouted slogans against the authorities, right across cities in Pakistan. They rose up unflinchingly to demand the restoration of a series of basic rights—from the right to form student unions to an end to sexual harassment. Among the student banners being euphorically paraded by the young in Lahore was one that carried the image of Bhagat Singh.[18]

In India, a protest erupted against three ordinances on agricultural marketing passed by the Modi government on 5 June 2020. The new laws passed hurriedly and without parliamentary consultation under cover of the dreadful COVID-19 pandemic were aimed at 'modernizing' Indian agriculture. The intention was to open it up to market forces. As the largest labour movement in human history began to gain momentum along Delhi's border in late 2020, Bhagat Singh's dead hand once again reached out to place itself reassuringly on the shoulders of the poor and the destitute. Before long, the numbers of the protestors had swelled to 1,25,000 farmers. Along the Tikri border in Delhi and Haryana's Bahadurgarh, the sea of humanity soon stretched to several kilometres. One in thirty of India's population now became embroiled in the agitation. With the farmers pouring in from all directions, a new-found cultural unity of Punjab and Haryana suddenly found expression in songs, dances and musical performances. The name of Bhagat Singh once again rang out in shrill expectant tones. Performances were held of the Haryanvi Raginis[19] to buoy up miraculously the morale of the drained and the deprived as one of the